

# Mae Saslaw

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## Curriculum Vitae

### Education

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Doctor of Philosophy, Geosciences 2025  
Stony Brook University, Stony Brook, New York

Bachelor of Science, Geology 2019  
*Magna Cum Laude*  
Portland State University, Portland, Oregon

Bachelor of Fine Arts, Writing 2009  
*Highest Honors, Department Award for Academic Achievement*  
Pratt Institute, Brooklyn, New York

### Research

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Earth Commons Postdoctoral Fellow 2025 – Present  
Environmental history of the Upper Susquehanna River  
Advised by Dr. Dagomar Degroot  
Georgetown University

Graduate Research Assistant 2019 – 2025  
Three records of the Cenozoic Turkana Basin from stable isotopes  
of soil carbonates and waters  
Advised by Dr. Gregory Henkes  
Stony Brook University Department of Geosciences

NSF Research Experience for Undergraduates Summer 2018  
Stable isotopes of surface water across Sauvie Island, Oregon  
Advised by Dr. John Bershaw  
Portland State University Center for Climate and Aerosol Research

### Teaching

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Guest Lecturer, Climate change in history Spring 2026  
Georgetown University Department of History

Teaching Assistant, Sedimentation and Stratigraphy Spring 2020 & 2025  
Stony Brook University Department of Geosciences

Guest Lecturer, Isotope Geochemistry Spring 2023 & 2024  
Stony Brook University Department of Geosciences

Guest Lecturer, Climate change and human evolution Spring 2022 & 2023  
Stony Brook University Department of Anthropology

Teaching Assistant, General Chemistry Fall 2020  
Stony Brook University Department of Chemistry

Teaching Assistant, Geology Field School Fall 2019  
Turkana Basin Institute and Stony Brook University

Teaching Assistant, Field Geology Fall 2019  
Stony Brook University Department of Geosciences

## *Curriculum Vitae*

### **Invited Talks**

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|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| Brown University — Climate and Environment Lunch Bunch Series               | Spring 2024 |
| City College of New York — Earth and Atmospheric Science Seminar            | Fall 2023   |
| Stony Brook University — Society for Women in Marine Science Speaker Series | Fall 2023   |

### **Awards**

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|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------|
| Three Minute Thesis Finalist<br>Stony Brook University                                   | 2023        |
| Distinguished Travel Award<br>Stony Brook University Graduate Student Organization       | 2022        |
| Excellence in Teaching Award<br>Stony Brook University Department of Geosciences         | 2021        |
| David E. King Field Work Award<br>Stony Brook University Department of Geosciences       | 2019 & 2020 |
| Pieper Merit Award<br>Stony Brook University Graduate School                             | 2019        |
| Best Poster<br>Association of Engineering Geologists Oregon Chapter Student Poster Night | 2019        |

### **Leadership & Service**

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|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| Member, American Association of University Professors<br>Georgetown University Chapter       | 2025 – Present |
| Graduate Peer Mentor Program Coordinator<br>Stony Brook University Department of Geosciences | 2024 – 2025    |
| Graduate Seminar Coordinator<br>Stony Brook University Department of Geosciences             | 2023 – 2025    |
| Organizer, Communications Workers of America<br>Local 1104 New York                          | 2020 – 2025    |
| Graduate Student Liaison<br>Stony Brook University Department of Geosciences                 | 2021 – 2023    |

### **Professional Activities**

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| Session Chair, Climate Change & Earth, Environmental, and Atmospheric Sciences<br>First International Symposium of Nonbinary Scientists     | 2025 |
| Co-Convener, Exploring changes in climate, flora, and fauna of Africa through the Cenozoic<br>Geological Society of America Connects        | 2023 |
| Participant, Preparing for an Academic Career in the Geosciences<br>National Association of Geoscience Teachers Earth Educators' Rendezvous | 2023 |

### Professional Organizations

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|-----------------------------------------------|----------------|
| International Society of Nonbinary Scientists | 2021 – Present |
| Geological Society of America                 | 2019 – Present |
| American Geophysical Union                    | 2018 – Present |

### Publications

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**Saslaw, M.**, Stinchcomb, G. E., Minya, A., Shedroff, S., Munoz, A., Esber, R., Batlay, A., Liutkus, C., Miller, E., Beck, C. C., Uno, K. T., Feibel C. S., Henkes, G. A. Warm temperatures and C<sub>3</sub> vegetation in the late Early Miocene Turkana Basin, Kenya from end-member stable isotopes of heterogenous soil carbonate nodules. (*in review*)

**Saslaw, M.**, Henkes, G. A., Green, D., Kirinya, M., Boyd, M., Hatton, K., Ngumbau, H., Mwangombe, H. 2025. Soil Temperature Measurements, 2019–2023, Turkana Basin Institute Research Centers, Kenya [dataset]. PANGAEA.  
<https://doi.org/10.1594/PANGAEA.981566>

**Saslaw, M.**, Yang, D., Lee, D., Poulsen, C. J., Henkes, G. A. An Isotope Mass Balance Analysis of Evaporative Loss From Lake Turkana, Kenya Using  $\delta^{18}\text{O}$  and  $\delta\text{D}$  of Natural Waters. 2024. *Water Resources Research*, 60(6).  
<https://doi.org/10.1029/2023WR036076>

Yang, D., **Saslaw, M.**, Henkes, G. 2024. Bayesian approach for modeling Lake Turkana water isotopes (v0.1.2). Zenodo. <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.10668927>

Leakey, A., Henkes, G., **Saslaw, M.**, Martins, D. 2023. Precipitation recorded in the Turkana Basin from 2005 to 2022 [dataset]. Stony Brook University Academic Commons. <https://commons.library.stonybrook.edu/geodata/8>

Jimenez, A., Bershaw, J., **Saslaw, M.**, Gall, S., Rahalski, E. 2023. Evaluating the Efficacy of Manmade Canals at Maintaining Lake Habitats for Salmon and Birds Using Seasonal Variations in Isotopes of Meteoric Water. ESS Open Archive.  
<https://doi.org/10.22541/essoar.168926403.34465563/v1>

Sousa, F. J., Cox, S. E., Hemming, S. R., Rasbury, E. T., Steponaitis, E., Hatton, K., **Saslaw, M.**, Henkes, G., Princehouse, P., Vitek, N. S., Nengo, I. 2022. New Discovery of Oligocene Strata in the Topernawi Formation, Turkana County, Kenya. *Frontiers in Earth Science*, 10. <https://doi.org/10.3389/feart.2022.799097>

### Presentations

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**Saslaw, M.**, Lee, D., Tweedy, R., Green, D., Uno, K., Poulsen, P., Henkes, G. 2024. Late Early Miocene Climate in the Turkana Basin, Kenya From Multi-Proxy Records and iCESM Results. American Geophysical Union Annual Meeting.

Pérez-Angel, L., Da, J., Flynn, A., Havranek, R., Novak, J., Romero, I., **Saslaw, M.**, Zhu, F. 2024. A new compilation of terrestrial temperatures during the Miocene. American Geophysical Union Annual Meeting.

*Continued*

## *Curriculum Vitae*

- Stiles, E., Novak, J., Mitsunaga, B., Hare, V., **Saslaw, M.**, Rugenstein, J., Beck, C., Jukar, A., George, S., Lee, D., Strömberg, C., Uno, K., Vetter, L., Zhu, F. 2024. Global Terrestrial Hydrologic Change Since the Mid-Miocene Climatic Optimum: A New Compilation of Hydroclimate Proxy Records and Implications for Future Change. American Geophysical Union Annual Meeting.
- Tweedy, R. R., de los Rios, N., **Saslaw, M.**, Henkes, G., Green, D. R., Stinchcomb, G., Lukens, W., Minya, A., Shedroff, S., TMP Scientific Team, Uno, K. T. 2024. Terrestrial Plant Wax Isotopes from Turkana Basin Reveal a Wetter, C<sub>3</sub> Environment During the Late Cenozoic. American Geophysical Union Annual Meeting.
- Tweedy, R., Uno, K., **Saslaw, M.**, Henkes, G., Feibel, C., Lukens, W.E., Stinchcomb, G. E., Liutkus-Pierce, C., Miller, E., Minya, A., Shedroff, S., Green, Daniel R., House, A., Bapana, S. 2024. Reconstructing Miocene Ecologies in the Turkana Basin: Insights from Plant Wax *n*-Alkanes. Geological Society of America *Abstracts with Programs* v. 56, no. 5.
- Hatton, K., Rasbury, E. T., Henkes, G., Sousa, F. J., Cox, S. E., Hemming, S., **Saslaw, M.**, Rossie, J.B., Cote, S. 2024. Fossil Wood-Associated Dolomite Records an Unusual Rift Related Fluid. Geological Society of America *Abstracts with Programs* v. 56, no. 5.
- Saslaw, M.**, Munoz, A., Stinchcomb, G., Minya, A., Shedroff, S., Esber, R., Batlay, A., Liutkus-Pierce, C., Miller, E., Beck, C., Feibel, C., Henkes, G. 2024. Paleoenvironmental Interpretations of Stable Isotopes From Miocene Pedogenic Carbonates with Diagenetic Calcite Components. 9th International Clumped Isotope Workshop, Stony Brook University.
- Saslaw, M.**, Stinchcomb, G., Shedroff, S., Minya, A., Liutkus-Pierce, C., Miller, E., Beck, C., Feibel, C., Henkes, G. 2024. Soil carbonates reveal paleoenvironments characterized by hot temperatures and C<sub>3</sub> vegetation in the late Early Miocene, Turkana Basin, Kenya. Miocene Climate Workshop: Exploring New Directions in Miocene Earth System Connections, University of Arizona.
- Saslaw, M.**, Lee, D., Poulsen, C., Liutkus-Pierce, C., Stinchcomb, G., Shedroff, S., Beck, C., Feibel, C., Miller, E., Henkes, G. 2023. Insights from ~17 Ma soil carbonate stable isotopes and GCM results in the Turkana Basin, Kenya. Geological Society of America *Abstracts with Programs*, v. 55, no. 6.
- Mengesha, M., Bedaso, Z., Beverly, E., Cerling, T., Henkes, G., Quade, J., Rogers, M., **Saslaw, M.**, Semaw, S., Levin, N. 2023. Assessing water stress using triple oxygen isotopes in soil carbonates in the Awash and Turkana regions of eastern Africa during the Pliocene and Pleistocene. Geological Society of America *Abstracts with Programs*, v. 55, no. 6.
- Esber, R., Stinchcomb, G., Beck, C., Mana, S., Batlay, A., Minya, A., **Saslaw, M.**, Beverly, E., Feibel, C., Henkes, G. 2023. Paleoenvironmental reconstruction of Locherangan, a Miocene fossil bearing locality, Turkana Basin, Kenya. Geological Society of America *Abstracts with Programs*, v. 55, no. 6.
- Batlay, A., Stinchcomb, G., Rowan, J., Beck, C., **Saslaw, M.**, Henkes, G. 2023. Exploring post-depositional processes in Late Miocene paleosols at Lothagam, Turkana Basin, Kenya. Geological Society of America *Abstracts with Programs*, v. 55, no. 6.

## *Curriculum Vitae*

- Hatton, K., Rasbury, T., Henkes, G., **Saslaw, M.**, Wooton, K., Hemming, S., Cox, S., Sousa, F., Rossie, J., Cote, S., Russo, G., Miller, E., Kappelman, J. 2023. Hydrothermal carbonates from Turkana, Kenya, preserve evidence of an unusual Middle Miocene thermal fluid pulse. Geological Society of America *Abstracts with Programs*, v. 55, no. 6.
- Bershaw, J., Jimenez, A., Greenwood, C., Petersen, N., **Saslaw, M.**, Mygatt, C. 2023. Stable Isotopes of Modern Water ( $\delta^2\text{H}$  and  $\delta^{18}\text{O}$ ) across the Pacific Northwest, USA: A Framework for Understanding Past, Present, and Future Climate. *Goldschmidt Abstracts*.
- Saslaw, M.**, Liutkus-Pierce, C., Stinchcomb, G., Shedroff, S., Uno, K.T, Tweedy, R., Beck, C., Feibel, C., Miller, E., Henkes, G. 2022. Soil carbonate clumped isotope temperatures and paleoenvironmental interpretations from the Miocene of the Turkana Basin, East Africa. Geological Society of America *Abstracts with Programs*, v. 54, no. 5.
- Stinchcomb, G, Liutkus-Pierce, C., Beck, C., **Saslaw, M.**, Shedroff, S., Minya, A., Winget, M., Tweedy, R., Rowan, C.M., Mana, S., Feibel, C., Henkes, G., Uno, K.T. 2022. Early Miocene climate and landscape change inferred from paleosols at Loperot, West Turkana, Kenya. Geological Society of America *Abstracts with Programs*, v. 54, no. 5.
- Saslaw, M.**, Henkes, G., Beck, C., Liutkus-Pierce, C., Feibel, C., Rowan, C.M., Boyd, M. 2021. Middle and Late Miocene paleoclimates from clumped isotopes of soil carbonates, Turkana Basin, East Africa. American Geophysical Union Fall Meeting.
- Jimenez, A., Bershaw, J., Gall, S., **Saslaw, M.** 2021. Using Isotope Tracers of Meteoric Water to Investigate the Effects of Hydraulic Restoration on Water Flux Across a Large River Island. American Geophysical Union Fall Meeting.
- Jimenez, A., Bershaw, J., Gall, S., **Saslaw, M.** 2021. Investigating the effects of hydrologic restoration on water flux across Sauvie Island, Oregon. Geological Society of America *Abstracts with Programs*, v. 53, no. 6.
- Henkes, G., **Saslaw, M.**, Feibel, C. 2020. Persistent warmth in the Turkana Basin, Kenya, from the Late Miocene until present day. American Geophysical Union Fall Meeting.
- Hatton, K., Rasbury, T., Henkes, G., **Saslaw, M.**, Wooton, K., Sousa, F., Cox, S., Steponaitis, E., Hemming, S.R., Cote, S., Northrup, P., Nengo, I., Present, T., Princehouse, P., Rossie, J.B., Tappero, R. 2020. U-Pb Dating of Oligocene-Miocene Petrified Wood Carbonates from the Turkana Basin, Kenya. American Geophysical Union Fall Meeting.
- Saslaw, M.** and Bershaw, J. 2018. Mixing of the Willamette and Columbia Rivers across Sauvie Island, Oregon based on stable isotopes ( $\delta^{18}\text{O}$  and  $\delta\text{D}$ ) of surface water. American Geophysical Union Fall Meeting.